

July 31, 2026

To Whom it May Concern,

Over the past three years as a Vista parent, I have come to deeply appreciate what makes Vista special. When our family first came to Vista, I was incredibly impressed by the school's charter, the quality of the teachers, and the culture they created. The teachers genuinely loved the students, enjoyed their work, and their enthusiasm was contagious. That positive environment is one of the reasons our family chose Vista and why I care so deeply about its future.

Like any school, Vista has experienced change. Some of those changes I have welcomed, while others I have questioned. My concern is not that changes have occurred, but rather how those changes have been communicated to parents.

Having served as PTO President for the past two years and continuing to serve on the PTO board, I have had the opportunity to hear from many Vista families. The concerns I am sharing are not based solely on my own experiences. They have been raised consistently by parents through PTO meetings, parent forums, school board meetings, emails, town halls, and the school's own annual parent surveys. This has given me a unique perspective on the recurring concerns families have expressed and the responses they have received.

Over the past several years, there has been a consistent pattern of significant decisions being communicated only after they have already been implemented or at the last possible moment. Major curriculum and testing changes were introduced with little or no opportunity for parents to understand them beforehand. Significant scheduling changes that directly impacted many students were announced only a week before school began, leaving families little time to prepare or provide meaningful feedback. Parents who sought clarification often felt their concerns were met with defensiveness rather than a willingness to engage in productive dialogue.

There have also been instances where teachers left during the school year, and families received little or no communication about who would be teaching their children or what the plan

was moving forward. In one case, parents waited nearly a month without updates before feeling they had to come to the school themselves to seek answers. Likewise, new administrators were hired and were interacting with students for weeks before parents were informed about who they were, what responsibilities they held, or how they would be involved in their children's education.

Individually, each of these situations may seem understandable. Collectively, however, they reveal a consistent pattern of inadequate communication and transparency.

This concern is not new. It has been raised repeatedly by individual parents, the PTO, and others through emails, parent forums, board meetings, surveys, and direct conversations with both the administration and the school board. Each year, the annual parent survey identifies communication as one of the most significant concerns among Vista families. Each year, both the board and administration acknowledge the concern and express a desire to improve. Unfortunately, many parents have not seen meaningful progress, and similar situations continue to occur.

At the same time, several governance decisions have understandably increased parents' concerns. The board chose to discontinue broadcasting board meetings, citing cost and logistical challenges. The board also transitioned from elected to appointed board positions, reduced the size of the board from seven members to five, and removed the requirement for a dedicated parent representative. While each of these decisions may have had legitimate reasons, together they have contributed to a perception among many parents that opportunities for transparency and parent involvement are becoming more limited rather than more accessible.

The PTO and numerous parents have asked the board to work with the administration to establish a clear communication policy outlining when and how significant decisions should be shared with families. Such a policy would create consistent expectations for everyone, increase transparency, and help rebuild trust between the school and its families. To my knowledge, no such policy has been developed, nor has there been clear accountability regarding the recurring communication concerns.

Communication is about far more than simply sending an email. It is the foundation of trust between a school and the families it serves. Parents understand that not every decision will be popular and that administrators sometimes have to make difficult choices. Most families are willing to support decisions they may not personally agree with when they feel they have been informed honestly, given adequate notice, and treated as valued partners in their children's education. When important information is delayed or omitted, parents begin to lose confidence—not necessarily because of the decisions themselves, but because they no longer feel included in the process.

I want to believe that these issues are not the result of intentional secrecy. I believe those serving on the board and in administration care deeply about Vista and are working hard on behalf of its students. However, after several years of repeated patterns, it has become increasingly difficult for many parents not to wonder whether important information is intentionally delayed until decisions are already final because there is concern about how families might respond.

Whether or not that perception is accurate, it is a problem in itself. Trust is built through openness, timely communication, and meaningful opportunities for parents to understand and provide input before significant decisions are finalized. When transparency is lacking, trust inevitably erodes.

My hope is that Vista can return to the partnership that originally drew so many families to the school. Parents do not expect to make every decision, nor should they. However, we do hope to be informed, respected, and included in conversations that significantly affect our children. I believe Vista has the opportunity to strengthen that partnership by establishing clear communication standards, increasing transparency, and demonstrating through consistent actions that parent voices truly matter.

Shyrel Wood